HOW TO READ THE SALES DASHBOARD

Quick guide • Sales performance by month, product, region, customer segment and payment method

1. Start with the KPI cards

KPI	What it means
Total Sales	Total recorded sales revenue.
Total Profit	Total profit from the recorded orders.
Total Orders / Quantity	Number of order IDs and total units sold.
Average Discount	Average discount percentage across records.
Average Profit Margin	Total Profit ÷ Total Sales; helps assess profitability, not just revenue.

2. Read the charts

Chart	How to interpret it
Sales & Profit Trend	Compare monthly sales and profit. Look for seasonal peaks, declines, or sales growth that is not matched by profit growth.
Sales by Category / Region	Identify categories and regions contributing the most revenue. Check profit as well before deciding what performs best.
Top 5 States / Cities	See the leading locations and consider where to focus marketing, inventory or further analysis.
Customer Segment / Payment Method	Compare purchasing groups and payment preferences to understand customer behavior.

3. Filter and refresh

Open the Dataset sheet and use the Excel table dropdown arrows to filter Region, Category, Order_Month or Customer_Segment. The table filter narrows source records; existing PivotCharts may not respond until you select Data → Refresh All. For fully interactive dashboard filtering, add Excel PivotTable slicers (Insert → Slicer) for Month and Region and connect each slicer to all relevant PivotTables using Report Connections.

4. Calculated fields and caveats

Order_Month groups each order date by month. **Profit_Margin** = Profit ÷ Sales. **Discount_Band** labels discounts as Low (<10%), Medium (10% to under 20%) or High (20%+). The data is sample data; validate data quality and confirm currency before business decisions.

Suggested reading order: KPI cards → monthly trend → category/region comparisons → locations → customer/payment patterns → filter and investigate.